Soundings

PROPOSAL

Reusable packaging for B2B deliveries

Project	Sustainability
Idea	GREEN-4
Status	Proposal
Owner	Zanele Dlamini
Exported	14 October 2026 by Kenji Watanabe
Score	Aggregate score 3.7 from 4 evaluations

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Summary

Deliver to business customers in returnable crates instead of cardboard.

Problem

Business customers get several boxes a week from us: about 70 tonnes of cardboard a year that they pay to dispose of.

Solution

Returnable crates, collected on the next delivery, starting with five large customers served by the north-west depot.

Market & users

Not written yet.

Cost & effort

About 2,400 crates at £18 each, plus washing at the depot. Crates last five years.

Benefits / revenue

Cardboard and tape savings of roughly £40,000 a year at full rollout, and a visible change customers asked for.

Carbon impact

About 95 t CO2e a year at full rollout (scope 3: packaging), from the supplier's cardboard footprint minus crate washing and the return trips, which ride on existing deliveries.

Risks

Crates that don't come back: a deposit per crate, in the contract (Legal agreed the clause).

Next steps / the ask

Not written yet.

Research and consultation

Not already being done elsewhere

Searched Soundings and asked logistics: a crate trial ran in 2022 for one customer and stopped when its contract ended.

Answered by Zanele Dlamini on 23 September 2026

Departments or teams consulted

Logistics (north-west depot), 20 Sep: crates fit the vans, collection on the next delivery works. Legal (contracts team), 22 Sep: fine if we keep the standard terms and add a deposit clause.

Answered by Zanele Dlamini on 23 September 2026

Data protection considered

Customer contact names only, already in the delivery system.

Answered by Zanele Dlamini on 23 September 2026